Northwind Analytics Employee Handbook (Synthetic Demo Corpus)

This fictional handbook is sample data for evaluating retrieval behaviour. It must not be used to make real employment, benefits, or expense decisions.

1. Employment Classifications

- Full-Time Employee (FTE): 40 hours per week and eligible for full benefits.
- Part-Time Employee: under 30 hours per week; eligible for prorated PTO but not health benefits.
- Contractor: engaged through a statement of work and not eligible for PTO or benefits under this handbook. Contractor terms are in an external addendum that is deliberately not included in this corpus.
- Intern: fixed-term; accrues PTO under Section 3.2 but is not eligible for the Section 5.1 401(k) match.

2. Team Structure

Team	Team Lead	Department
Platform Engineering	Priya Raman	Engineering
Data Science	Marcus Oyelaran	Engineering
Customer Success	Dana Whitfield	Revenue
Sales	Jordan Kessler	Revenue
People Ops	Alicia Fenn	Operations

Department Heads are Sam Torres (Engineering), Naomi Fields (Revenue), and Alicia Fenn (Operations). A Department Head provides second-line approval when a Team Lead escalates an exception.

3. Paid Time Off

3.1 Standard Accrual

FTEs accrue 1.25 PTO days each month (15 days each year) for their first three years of tenure.

3.2 Tenure-Based Increases

- Years 0-3: 15 days each year.
- Years 3-7: 20 days each year.
- Years 7+: 25 days each year.

Interns accrue 0.5 PTO days per month, capped at five days per internship term.

3.3 Carryover

Up to five unused PTO days carry into the next calendar year. An employee who transfers teams mid-year may carry up to 10 days in that year if the receiving Team Lead co-signs the request.

3.4 PTO During a Notice Period

An employee may not take PTO during an active resignation notice period without Department Head approval. This overrides the normal Team Lead approval rule.

4. Exceptions and Approval Chains

4.1 Team Transfers

A team transfer needs sign-off from the current and receiving Team Leads. When the transfer crosses departments, the losing and receiving Department Heads must also approve.

4.2 General Exception Rule

Most exceptions, including early benefits eligibility and one-time PTO advances, need Team Lead approval only. Section 3.4 is a named exception and instead needs Department Head approval.

4.3 Remote Work Exceptions

Platform Engineering and Data Science employees need Team Lead approval for permanent remote status. Customer Success and Sales employees need both Team Lead and Department Head approval because they are client-facing under Section 6.1.

5. Benefits

5.1 401(k) Match

FTEs are eligible for a 4% 401(k) match after 90 days of employment. Interns and Part-Time employees are not eligible.

5.2 Health Benefits

FTEs are eligible for health benefits from day one. Part-Time employees are not eligible regardless of tenure.

5.3 Early Benefits Eligibility Exception

A Part-Time employee who moves to FTE mid-quarter can request a waiver of the normal eligibility waiting period through the Section 4.2 general exception rule: Team Lead approval only.

6. Client-Facing Role Policies

6.1 Definition

Customer Success and Sales are client-facing roles. This classification affects remote work approval (Section 4.3) and expense policy (Section 7.2).

7. Expenses

7.1 Standard Expense Approval

Expenses below $500 need Team Lead approval only.

7.2 Client Entertainment Expenses

Client-facing employees may submit client entertainment expenses up to $1,000 with Team Lead approval. Non-client-facing employees need Department Head approval for any entertainment expense.